

How Your Website Works (Simple Non-Technical Guide)

A crystal-clear explanation of the two pieces of your platform: the Vercel Storefront and the Supabase Vault.

Audience: Non-Technical Founders

Concept: Storefront vs Back-Office Safe

Status: Concept Confirmed

Yes, you are 100% correct! Your understanding is spot on: we are building the **Database** (to remember everything) and putting the website on the **Vercel Server** (so the public can visit it anytime).

1. Think of Your Website Like a Physical Store

Building an online platform is just like opening a physical travel agency or hotel in the real world. It has two essential parts:

Part 1: The Showroom / Storefront (Vercel)

This is what people SEE and TOUCH:

- The beautiful homepage, buttons, colors, and search bar.
- The California studio photos and London Eye cards.
- When someone types `roammeet.vercel.app` on their phone in London or California, **Vercel is the host that delivers the website to their screen** in half a second.
- It ensures the store is open 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, and never closes.

Part 2: The Safe / Digital Vault (Supabase Database)

This is what REMEMBERS everything:

- The safe in the back office where all real customer records are kept.
- When a traveler registers, where does their password go? **Supabase.**
- When someone chats or uploads an Aadhaar/Passport, where is it saved? **Supabase.**
- When someone pays the \$1 / ₹79 fee, where is the record locked? **Supabase.**

2. Why Do We Need Both to Work Together?

- **Without Vercel (No Showroom):** You would have a database, but no one could see or open your website on their phone.
- **Without Supabase (No Database):** People could see the website, but as soon as they refreshed the page, all accounts, messages, and bookings would disappear like drawing on water.
- **With Both (Full Platform):** Customers visit the showroom (Vercel), and every booking, chat, and verified profile is permanently saved in the digital vault (Supabase).

3. What Does This Mean for You (The Founder)?

You do NOT need any technical background:

- I handle 100% of the code, terminal commands, database setup, and technical connections for you.
- All you will ever do is sign up for a free Supabase account (just like signing up for Gmail) and copy-paste two text keys.
- From that moment on, you and your partner can run your travel community smoothly from your browser!